The Silent Floor / Room 309

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1. CORE IDEA

A psychological-horror indie game set inside a hotel where the protagonist's perception breaks down after emotional stress and exhaustion. As he tries to leave his room in search of help, the hotel distorts, shifts, and traps him in an ever-worsening maze of hallucinations.

2. TONE & STYLE

- Liminal hallways
- Minimal UI
- Realistic hotel ambience that slowly becomes uncanny
- Subtle horror escalates into aggressive hallucinations
- Inspired by **Exit 8, Captured, PT, Fears to Fathom**
- Horror from perception, not monsters

3. NARRATIVE OVERVIEW

- The protagonist wakes up in his hotel suite after a long night of work. His partner calls, and they argue but he cannot speak despite trying.
- He reaches for his medication but can't find it.
- When he tries to call room service, the phone line is dead.
- He steps out of his room to seek help, and the psychological descent begins.
- The hotel becomes a distorted reflection of his inner state, culminating in a climactic escape attempt that blurs perception and reality.

4. MAIN CHARACTERS

Protagonist
An overworked professional experiencing early-stage psychological instability that affects speech and perception.

Partner
Only heard through phone calls. A grounding voice that slowly becomes distorted.

Hotel Staff
Ambiguous silhouettes and figures unclear if real or hallucinated.

5. GAMEPLAY STRUCTURE

- Walking exploration
- Minimal interactions (doors, notes, objects, phone)
- Environmental distortion
- Jump scares and micro-scares
- No combat.
- Looping corridors
- Visual distortions
- Phone call distortions
- Mirrors behaving differently
- Hotel staff hallucinations

- Impossible geometry
- Returning to the same hallway despite moving forward
- Running forward makes the world move forward instead of the player.

6. CORE GAME FLOW

Event 1 — Hotel Suite (Pre-Distortion)

Phone Call

- The protagonist wakes up.
- Receives a call from his partner.
- They argue, he tries to speak but cannot.
- Call cuts abruptly.

Objective 1: "Take your medication."
The player searches through his belongings.

Event 1A: "Find the Meds" (Six Integrated Scare Sequences)

1. Searching for the Meds (Exploration Event)

The player checks:

- Suitcase
- Side table
- Bag

The meds are missing.
Anxiety rises.

"I… put them here…"

SCARE #1 - Corner Silhouette

As the player finishes searching, a tall dark silhouette appears in the corner for less than a second and vanishes.
Low ominous rumble.

2. Calling Room Service

The player picks up the hotel phone.
There is **no dial tone** — only faint static.
After a few seconds, a subtle whisper leaks in.
If the player waits longer:

SCARE #2 - Audio Spike
A sudden loud distortion:

"Hello?—"

The line cuts.
The phone goes completely dead.

Objective updates:

"Step outside and ask for help."

3. Approaching the Door

As the player walks toward the exit:

SCARE #3 - Running Footsteps Behind You
Fast footsteps sprint toward him from behind, but nothing appears.
A light flickers.

4. Opening the Door

The protagonist opens the door.
Immediately:

SCARE #4 - Hallway Shadow Dash
A humanoid shadow darts across the hallway from left to right.
Silent, fast, unnatural.

When the player fully steps out, the hallway looks normal again.

5. Entering the Hallway

As the player crosses the threshold:

SCARE #5 - Door Slam & Wrong Room Number
His hotel room door **slams shut** behind him.
The room number has changed (e.g., from 309 to 308).
The hallway lighting dims momentarily.

6. Taking First Steps Down the Hall

Ambient hum deepens.
The sense of isolation grows.

SCARE #6 - Whisper in the Ear
A clear whisper in the player's right ear:
"Don't go."
No one is nearby.

Transition to Event 2

After several steps:
Next Objective:
"Find the front desk."
At this point, the corridor looping and heavy hallucinations begin.

7. CLIMAX - Approach to the Lobby

The player finally reaches the lobby flooded in bright morning light.
He sees an exit door glowing and peaceful.

8. The Window

As he walks toward the exit, the light intensifies.
The door melts visually into the shape of a **window**.
He steps through.
Blackout.

9. THEMES

- Unreliable perception
- Stress, overwhelm, emotional collapse
- Isolation in public spaces
- “Escape” as an illusion
- Hotel as a metaphor for the mind

10. AUDIO & VISUAL STYLE

- Realistic environments
- Slight film noise
- Warm light turning cold over time
- Distorted phone audio
- Whisper-level spatial sound
- Sudden audio voids and sharp spikes

11. Story Brief

The man wakes up slumped over a study table in a hotel suite, the quiet hum of the building pressing in around him. Papers are scattered. A laptop screen glows dimly. The city outside the window is distant and muted, like it belongs to another place entirely.

His phone rings.

It's his partner. The conversation begins like any argument born from distance — missed calls, unanswered messages, frustration built over time. She's upset. He tries to respond, but when he opens his mouth, nothing comes out. No matter how hard he tries, his voice refuses to surface. On the other end of the line, her tone shifts from anger to confusion, then worry. She asks why he's silent. Why he won't answer her.

Before he can do anything, the call cuts off.

Shaken, he tells himself it's stress. Exhaustion. He reaches for his medication — something familiar, something grounding — but it isn't there. He searches his bag, his suitcase, the drawers. Nothing. The room begins to feel subtly wrong. The air feels heavier. Sounds linger longer than they should.

As he straightens up, for just a split second, a tall shadow stands in the corner of the room.

Then it's gone.

Trying to calm himself, he picks up the hotel phone to call room service. There's no dial tone. Only static. Faint, breath-like sounds slip through the line, as if someone is almost speaking. He waits, listening — and suddenly a distorted voice breaks through for an instant before the line dies completely.

With no other option, he decides to step outside and ask for help.

As he walks toward the door, he hears it.

Footsteps.

Fast. Running. Closing in behind him.

His heart pounds as the sound rushes closer — and then stops just as his hand reaches the door handle. He swings the door open—

—and a dark, shadowy figure darts across the hallway in front of him, vanishing around the corner in an instant. It makes no sound. It doesn't look back. It's gone before he can process what he saw.

The hallway is empty.

He steps out anyway.

The door to his room slams shut behind him with a violent crack. When he turns around, the room number is wrong. The lights dim briefly, like the building itself has blinked.

As he takes his first steps down the corridor, whispers slide past his ears. Not clear words — just fragments. Breathing. Warnings. Something close enough to feel, but never close enough to see.

He starts walking.

The hotel begins to change.

Hallways stretch longer than they should. Corridors loop back on themselves. He passes the same doors again and again, each time slightly altered. Figures appear at the far ends of hallways — hotel staff, guests, shapes pretending to be people — but they vanish the moment he gets close.

Sometimes he hears footsteps behind him again. Sometimes something moves just out of sight. Sometimes a door that wasn't there before waits for him, as if expecting him to open it.

His phone buzzes with fragments of his partner's voice, replayed out of order. Notes begin to appear — some left by guests, some written in his own handwriting, describing things he doesn't remember doing. Mirrors stop behaving properly. Reflections lag, stare back too long, or show someone else entirely.

The hotel stops feeling like a place and starts feeling like a test.

At times, the environment turns openly hostile. Running doesn't always help — sometimes the hallway stretches instead, swallowing distance. Standing still feels dangerous. Trusting the wrong door, the wrong sound, the wrong instinct can end everything in an instant, forcing him back to moments that feel familiar but never quite the same.

Eventually, after what feels like hours, the pressure breaks.

The space opens up. The noise fades. Warm light fills wide corridors. The hotel feels calm again — too calm. Ahead lies the lobby, bright and empty, bathed in soft morning light. At the far end, an exit door glows gently, promising release.

As he approaches, the world begins to lose detail. Sound drains away. The light becomes overwhelming. Only at the last moment does he realize something is wrong — the door's shape isn't right.

It isn't a door at all.

It's a window.

He steps forward.

Everything goes black.

When he opens his eyes, hands grip his shoulders. Voices call out to him. Paramedics kneel beside him, asking if he can hear them. He collapsed in the hallway. He’s alive.

As he’s carried away, he catches one final glimpse of the hotel lobby through the glass. The lights flicker softly.

And for just a moment, a dark silhouette stands inside, watching him leave.

Core Gameplay Mechanics

CORE GAMEPLAY MECHANICS

1. PLAYER PERSPECTIVE & CONTROLS

1.1 Camera & View

- First-person perspective
- No visible player body in direct view
- Player reflections are visible in mirrors, glass, and reflective surfaces
- Reflections may subtly desync from player movement in later phases

1.2 Movement

- Standard WASD movement with mouse-look
- Movement is slightly weighted to enhance tension and vulnerability

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2. ENVIRONMENTAL INTERACTION SYSTEM

The player can interact with the environment in a grounded, tactile manner.

2.1 Interactable Objects

- Doors (main doors, interior doors, forbidden doors)
- Drawers and cabinets
- Bags and personal belongings
- Phones, notes, and small props
- Mirrors and reflective surfaces

2.2 Interaction Philosophy

- Interactions are slow and deliberate
- Animations prioritize realism over speed
- Player vulnerability is reinforced during interaction

Interacting with the environment is a core method of progression and information gathering.

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3. SPATIAL LOOPING & ENVIRONMENTAL MANIPULATION

The hotel environment can dynamically distort space and logic.

3.1 Loop Types

- Horizontal loops: corridors repeat or extend endlessly
- Vertical loops: stairwells and elevators return the player to the same floor
- Room loops: exiting through interior doors leads back to the main entrance

3.2 Progression Rules

- Loops persist until the player identifies the correct behavior, exit, or condition
- Progression relies on observation rather than explicit instruction
- Environmental cues subtly indicate correct or incorrect actions

The environment acts as an antagonist, enforcing rules without explanation.

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4. NOTES & ENVIRONMENTAL STORYTELLING

Notes serve both narrative and mechanical purposes.

4.1 Types of Notes

- Notes written by the player character
- Notes written by an unknown individual
- Clinical or observational notes appearing later in the game

4.2 Function

- Provide hints for environmental rules
- Introduce doubt about authorship and reality
- Reinforce themes of fractured perception

Notes may contradict each other and should never provide complete clarity.

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5. THE SHADOW ENTITY

5.1 Role

The Shadow is not a traditional enemy but a **rule enforcer** tied to environmental logic.

5.2 Behavior

- Appears based on player actions, not scripted combat encounters
- Observes from a distance or through reflections
- Rarely moves directly toward the player
- Does not chase in conventional terms

5.3 Function

- Punishes rule violations
- Reinforces behavioral learning
- Maintains constant psychological pressure

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6. DEATH & CHECKPOINT SYSTEM

6.1 Death Conditions

The player can die due to:

- Entering forbidden doors
- Violating environmental rules
- Remaining idle in unsafe zones
- Misinterpreting spatial logic
- Triggering Shadow enforcement

6.2 Checkpoints

- The game autosaves at key progression points
- After death, the player respawns at the last checkpoint
- The environment remains largely unchanged after death

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7. ENVIRONMENT RULES MATRIX

This section defines how the environment reacts to player behavior. The hotel operates on invisible rules that the player must learn through observation and consequence rather than instruction.

7.1 Core Rule Philosophy

- Every space has conditions
- Safety is temporary and contextual
- Familiar rules can change without warning

The environment is reactive, not random.

7.2 Rule Examples

Player Action	Environment Response	Outcome
Opens forbidden or wrong door	Immediate environmental punishment	Death / Reset
Repeats same corridor path	Corridor loops or extends	Disorientation
Stands still too long	Audio fades / vision desaturates	Death
Follows sound cues blindly	Shadow proximity increases	High risk
Observes before acting	Environment stabilizes briefly	Progress

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8. PUZZLE & PROGRESSION DESIGN

Puzzles are environmental, psychological, and rule-based rather than logic-based.

8.1 Puzzle Types

- Correct exit identification
- Observation-based navigation
- Behavioral puzzles (movement, stillness, attention)
- Audio-driven misdirection
- Reflection and mirror logic

8.2 Wrong Choice Consequences

- Wrong doors can instantly kill the player
- Incorrect behavior reinforces incorrect rules
- Puzzles often reset subtly rather than clearly failing

There is no confirmation of success until progression occurs.

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9. NARRATIVE DESIGN

Narrative is delivered indirectly through environment, notes, and audio.

9.1 Narrative Tools

- Environmental storytelling
- Notes and written fragments
- Audio cues and voice fragments
- Spatial memory and repetition

9.2 Notes System

- Notes may be handwritten or typed
- Some notes contradict earlier information
- Authorship is intentionally unclear

9.3 Player Interpretation

The game avoids explicit exposition. Meaning is formed through:

- Pattern recognition
- Emotional inference

THE SHADOW

THE SHADOW

Not an enemy. A rule enforcer.

CORE

- The shadow is **not hostile by default**
- It **never attacks randomly**
- It appears only when the player **breaks or misunderstands rules**
- It punishes **behavior**, not location
- The player must learn:
  "If it appeared, I did something wrong."

This keeps fear **fair and psychological**.

SHADOW STATES

The shadow operates in **3 distinct states**, unlocked across phases.

STATE 1:- OBSERVER

Active In: Phases 1–3
Threat Level: Non-lethal (with one exception)

Behavior

- Appears briefly
- Maintains distance
- Never approaches
- Never blocks paths
- Often silent

Appearance Rules

- Peripheral vision
- Long-distance corridor
- Reflections (Phase 3)
- One-time scripted passes (Phase 1 dash)

Kill Conditions (LIMITED)

- Player stares too long (Phase 2+)
- Player touches mirror reflection (Phase 3)

Purpose

- Condition fear
- Teach restraint

- Establish presence
  The shadow watches, but does not hunt.

STATE 2:- WARNING

Active In: Phase 4
Threat Level: Conditional lethal

Behavior

- Appears closer
- Blocks paths briefly
- Forces rerouting
- Signals impending danger

Warning Cues (ALWAYS CONSISTENT)

At least **two** must occur before death is possible:

- Audio: low-frequency rumble
- Visual: shadow flicker / distortion
- Environmental: lights dim or stretch
- Player feedback: heavier breathing

Kill Conditions

- Player ignores warning cues
- Player repeats a forbidden behavior
- Player approaches shadow deliberately

Purpose

- Enforce learned rules
- Create pressure without instant punishment
  If the shadow is here, the player still has time.

STATE 3:- HUNTER

Active In: Late Phase 4, Phase 5 (rare), Phase 6 (symbolic only)
Threat Level: Lethal

Behavior

- Actively closes distance
- Cannot be outrun traditionally
- Does not chase for long
- Appears suddenly, disappears suddenly

Kill Conditions

- Player panics
- Player runs incorrectly
- Player freezes too long

Important Rule

- The shadow **never chases for more than 3–5 seconds**.
- Fear comes from inevitability, not pursuit.

GLOBAL SHADOW RULES

1. **No Random Appearances**
    - Every appearance has a trigger
2. **No Silent Kill**
    - Death is always preceded by a cue
3. **No Combat**
    - Shadow cannot be fought or stunned
4. **No Persistence**
    - Shadow disappears after teaching its lesson
5. **No Overuse**
    - Max 1–2 shadow events per gameplay segment.

PLAYER BEHAVIOR TRIGGERS

The shadow responds to **how the player behaves**, not where they go.

TRIGGER LIST

Player Action	Shadow Response
Staring too long	Appear / kill
Touching mirrors	Instant kill
Running excessively	Warning → kill
Standing still too long	Appear
Ignoring audio cues	Appear closer
Trusting false objectives	Appear
Approaching shadow	Kill

PHASE-BY-PHASE SHADOW USAGE

PHASE 1

- One scripted dash
- One audio-based presence
- Zero lethal capability

PHASE 2

- Distant observation
- Stare-based death
- No pursuit
- Acts as “don’t do that again” sign

PHASE 3

- Reflection-only presence
- Mirror-based deaths
- Never physically present

PHASE 4

- Full warning system unlocked
- Path blocking
- Short pursuit
- Behavior punishment begins

PHASE 5

- Rare appearances
- Passive watching
- Psychological pressure only
- Almost never kills

PHASE 6

- Appears once
- Silent
- Symbolic
- No interaction

DEATH PRESENTATION

- No gore
- No long animation
- 0.5–1 second maximum
- Blackout immediately

Fear comes from **anticipation**, not spectacle.

PLAYER LEARNING CURVE

Phase	Player Learns
1	Shadow exists
2	Observation is dangerous
3	Reflection is lethal
4	Behavior matters
5	Comfort is suspicious
6	Escape was illusion

EVENT STRUCTURE

Event STRUCTURE

Total Target Runtime: ~1–1.5 Hours

Event 1 - THE INTERRUPTION

Target Playtime: 12–15 minutes
Tone: Subtle psychological dread
Purpose: Establish reality, helplessness, and fear *fast*
Player Safety: No deaths possible
Core Theme: *Loss of control begins internally*

SCENE 1: AWAKENING

Duration: 1–2 minutes
Location: Hotel Suite – Study Area

Player Start State

- Screen fades in from black
- Camera locked for 3 seconds
- Slight head sway (as if waking)
- Low tinnitus tone fades in, then out

Environment Details

- Mid-range hotel suite (not luxury, not cheap)
- Neutral colors: beige, muted green, brown wood
- Desk lamp ON
- Laptop open (blurred spreadsheet / report)
- Half-drunk coffee (cold)
- Suit jacket on chair
- Suitcase near bed, half open
- Night outside window (city lights, rain optional)

Audio

- HVAC hum
- Distant traffic
- Clock ticking (important motif)

SCENE 2: THE PHONE CALL

Duration: 3–4 minutes
Trigger: Phone rings automatically after ~10 seconds.

Phone Rings

- Normal ringtone
- No distortion at first

Call Structure (Natural, Not Horror)

1. Partner is annoyed (missed call, work obsession)
2. Mild argument
3. Partner pauses, waiting for response
4. Player input disabled (cannot speak)
5. Partner gets frustrated:
    - “Why aren’t you saying anything?”
6. Tone shifts to concern
7. Player breathing becomes audible
8. Partner: “Are you there?”
9. Call cuts suddenly (no glitch, just dead)

Audio

- Player breathing mixed louder than partner
- Silence after call is **too quiet** (clock still ticking)

SCENE 3: MEDICATION SEARCH

Duration: 2–3 minutes
Objective Appears (Minimal UI):
Find your medication

Searchable Items

- Suitcase
- Backpack
- Bathroom cabinet
- Desk drawer
- Jacket pockets

Environmental Storytelling

- Prescription bottle label visible but empty
- Crumpled blister pack
- Note on phone: “Don’t forget meds”

FIRST VISUAL HALLUCINATION

Trigger: After final container checked

Execution:

- Dark humanoid silhouette in peripheral vision
- Appears for <0.3 seconds
- No sound
- Vanishes if player turns head

Rule:

- Happens once
- Cannot repeat
- Cannot approach

Player Emotion

"Did I imagine that?"

SCENE 4: ROOM SERVICE PHONE

Duration: 1–2 minutes
Objective Updates:

Call room service

Phone Interaction

- Pick up hotel phone

Audio Progression

1. No dial tone
2. Static
3. Subtle whisper under static
4. Player waits → distortion surge
5. Sudden loud glitch burst
6. Silence

Important Rule

- Player cannot hang up during the distortion
- Forced helplessness

Objective Updates:

Step outside and ask for help

SCENE 5: APPROACHING THE DOOR

Duration: 1–2 minutes
Location: Inside hotel room

Environmental Shift

- Lights flicker once
- HVAC hum lowers pitch
- Corridor ambience faintly audible through door

FOOTSTEP JUMPSCARE

Trigger: Player within 2m of door
Execution:

- Full sprinting footsteps from behind
- Doppler-like rush
- Stop instantly
- No impact
- No visual

Player Response

Turning around reveals:

- Empty room
- Everything unchanged

SCENE 6: FIRST HALLWAY REVEAL

Duration: ~1 minutes
Trigger: Player opens door

SHADOW DASH SCARE

- Shadow figure sprints across hallway
- Left → Right
- Silent
- No collision
- No interaction

Corridor Appearance

- Normal hotel hallway
- Neutral lighting
- Carpeted
- Doors closed
- Exit sign far away

Silence

After the shadow:

- 3–4 seconds of near silence
- Only HVAC remains

SCENE 7: COMMITMENT MOMENT

Duration: ~30 seconds
Location: Corridor

Player Steps Out

- Door closes slowly behind them

DOOR SLAM EVENT

- Loud, sudden slam
- Player locked out

Environmental Distortion (Very Light)

- Room number on door changes
- Light flickers
- Corridor feels longer

WHISPER EVENT

- Directional whisper (right ear):
  "Don't go."
- No source.

SCENE 8: FINDING THE FRONT DESK (FALSE HOPE)

Duration: 2–3 minutes
Objective:
Find the front desk

Corridor Design

- Straight hallway
- Slight bend near end
- Carpet pattern subtly leads forward
- Ceiling lights brighter ahead

Guidance

- Small sign at far end:
  ← **Elevators / Lobby**

Audio Pull

- Distant elevator chime
- Faint lobby murmur (barely audible)

Doors Along Corridor

- Locked
- Normal hotel feedback
- No scares

This reinforces **normalcy**.

SCENE 9: ELEVATOR ALCOVE

Duration: 1–2 minutes
Location: End of corridor

Elevator Details

- Two elevator doors
- Floor indicator OFF
- Call button works normally
- Neutral lighting

Player Interaction

- Press call button
- Elevator arrives promptly

Subtle Distortion (Only if player waits)

- Ceiling creak
- Flicker once
- No threat

SCENE 10: TRANSITION TO Event 2

Duration: 1 minute

Elevator Interior

- Clean
- Mirror on back wall
- Floor buttons unlabeled
- Soft elevator music

Player Steps In

- Doors close
- Music plays
- Short fade to black

Event 1 Checkpoint

- Silent checkpoint after elevator doors close
- Reload returns player inside elevator

Event 2 - THE WRONG FLOOR

Target Playtime: 15–20 minutes
Tone: Confusion → Suspicion → Fear
Player Safety: Limited (first lethal encounters)
Core Theme: *The environment lies, confidently*
Design Rule:

The player must believe **they made the mistake**, not the game.

Event 2 GOALS

- Introduce looping navigation
- Introduce lethal doors
- Teach distrust of sound and signage
- Introduce shadow as a **warning system**
- Establish checkpoint + death loop rhythm
- Make player cautious, slow, and observant

SCENE 1: THE ELEVATOR DESCENT

Duration: ~1 minutes
Location: Elevator Interior

Elevator Behavior

- Doors close normally
- Elevator music plays
- No floor indicator movement
- Slight delay (longer than normal)

Subtle Distortion

- Music pitch lowers slightly
- Elevator hum deepUM slightly off-rhythm
- Mirror reflection lags by a fraction of a second (NOT lethal yet)

Trigger

Elevator *stops abruptly*.
No jolt. Just silence.

SCENE 2: THE WRONG FLOOR REVEAL

Duration: 3–4 minutes
Location: New Hotel Corridor

Doors Open To:

- Corridor similar to previous
- But:
    - Lighting slightly colder
    - Ceiling marginally lower
    - Carpet pattern reversed

Immediate Clue (Non-Explicit)

- Room numbers start mid-sequence (e.g., 317, 319)
- No visible lobby signage
- Elevator indicator still blank

Audio

- Corridor hum louder
- No ambient city noise

Objective (Appears After 10 Seconds)

Find the front desk

Same objective. Different meaning.

SCENE 3: INITIAL EXPLORATION (SAFE CONFUSION)

Duration: 5–6 minutes
Location: Corridor Loop Zone A

Corridor Layout

- Rectangular loop
- 6–8 doors
- One side has a window at the end (fake depth)

Loop Behavior

- Player walks straight → returns subtly to same point
- Loop is *not obvious*
- Furniture slightly shifts position each loop

Notes Introduced (First Time)

- Folded note on carpet:
  "This isn't the lobby."

Player Learning

Navigation is unreliable - but not dangerous yet.

SCENE 4: FIRST LETHAL DOOR

Duration: 4–6 minutes
Location: Corridor Loop Zone A

Door Setup

- One door slightly ajar
- Warm light inside
- Looks inviting

Nearby Note

"I shouldn't have opened that one."

Player Choice

- Ignore door → progress continues
- Open door → **instant death**

DEATH #1 - FORBIDDEN DOOR

Execution

- Door opens halfway
- Sudden blackout
- Loud, distorted noise burst
- No visual clarity

Restart

- Silent checkpoint
- Player returns outside door
- Door now fully closed

Rule Taught

Some doors kill instantly.

SCENE 5: SHADOW OBSERVATION INTRO

Duration: 2–3 minutes
Location: Corridor Loop Zone B

Shadow Appearance

- At far end of hallway
- Standing still
- Partially obscured by darkness

Rule

- If player stares >3 seconds → death
- If player looks away → shadow vanishes

DEATH #2 - OBSERVATION DEATH

Execution

- Shadow snaps forward
- Single frame close-up
- Blackout

Lesson

Observation is dangerous.

SCENE 6: SOUND-BASED MISDIRECTION

Duration: 2–3 minutes
Location: Corridor Loop Zone B

Audio Design

- Distant voice calling player's name
- Voice sounds familiar (partner)
- Comes from wrong direction

Mechanics

- Following voice leads to tighter loops
- Ignoring voice progresses player

Optional Death

- Voice corridor narrows
- Audio becomes overwhelming
- Blackout

Lesson

Voices lie.

SCENE 7: FALSE PROGRESS & ROOM NUMBERS

Duration: 3–4 minutes
Location: Corridor Loop Zone C

Visual Trick

- Room numbers suddenly reset
- Player sees familiar number (their room)
- Door identical to original

Interaction

- Opening door:
    - Empty room
    - Different layout
    - Wrong proportions
    - Immediate unease

No Death Here

This is psychological punishment.

SCENE 8: ESCALATING LOOPS

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Loop Intensification

- Ceiling lowers each loop
- Lights flicker longer
- Notes contradict each other

Example Notes:

- “The left side is safer.”
- “The left side killed me.”

Player Learns

There is no universal truth.

SCENE 9: EXIT DISCOVERY

Duration: 3–4 minutes

Environmental Cue

- Corridor ends in emergency exit sign
- EXIT sign flickers
- Door labeled “STAIRS”

Nearby Note

> “Down isn’t down.”

SCENE 10: Event TRANSITION

Duration: 1–2 minutes
Location: Stairwell Entrance

Player Interaction

- Opens stairwell door
- Stairwell is unnaturally tall
- Light far below

Shadow Final Event 2 Appearance

- Shadow visible one floor down
- Looking too long still kills

Checkpoint

- Upon stepping into stairwell
- Door closes behind player

Event 3 - DISPLACEMENT

Target Playtime: 30–35 minutes
Tone: Disorientation → Anxiety → Cognitive Breakdown
Player Safety: Moderate (environmental deaths)
Core Theme: *Space, memory, and reflection cannot be trusted*
Design Rule:

> Horizontal logic is broken.
> Vertical logic is broken.
> Reflections know more than the player.

Event 3 GOALS

- Introduce vertical horror (stairs & elevators)
- Introduce mirrors as **informational but lethal**
- Destroy trust in memory and handwriting
- Escalate fear without chases

- Make the player feel mentally unstable, not physically threatened

SCENE 1: THE STAIRWELL DESCENT

Duration: 3–4 minutes
Location: Stairwell (from Event 2)

Environment

- Concrete stairwell
- Emergency lighting (cold white)
- Very tall vertical shaft
- Echo-heavy acoustics

Player Action

- Walk downward
- Footsteps echo inconsistently
- Count of floors feels wrong

Subtle Distortion

- Floor numbers on landings repeat
- Same number appears twice
- No death here

Emotional Goal

> "I'm going down… but not progressing."

SCENE 2: STAIRWELL LOOP

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Loop Logic

- After several floors, player returns to same landing
- Player notices identical wall stain / crack
- Exit door appears identical each time

Audio

- Breathing louder
- Distant door slams above or below (never visible)

Player Learning

Vertical movement cannot be trusted.

SCENE 3: STAIRWELL EXIT

Duration: 2–3 minutes

Exit Door

- Unmarked
- Slight light bleed underneath
- No signage

Interaction

- Opening door breaks loop
- Player enters hotel corridor

Checkpoint triggers here.

SCENE 4: MIRROR CORRIDOR INTRO

Duration: 4–5 minutes
Location: Narrow corridor with mirrors

Environment

- Mirrors on one wall
- Soft lighting
- Carpet muffles footsteps

Mirror Behavior (NON-LETHAL INTRO)

- Reflection lags slightly
- Reflection sometimes looks at doors the player hasn't noticed
- Reflection blinks independently

Rule

Mirrors give **information**, not safety.

SCENE 5: FIRST MIRROR DEATH

Duration: 3–5 minutes

Setup

- Door only visible in reflection
- Player must use mirror to locate it

Death Trigger

- Player touches mirror surface
- Or stands too close too long

DEATH - MIRROR CONTACT

Execution

- Reflection moves first
- Grabs player's wrist

- Screen fractures
- Blackout

Restart
- Player respawns before mirror corridor
- Mirror behavior unchanged

Lesson
Look, don't touch.

SCENE 6: HANDWRITING ROOMS

Duration: 5–6 minutes
Location: Guest rooms accessed via corridor

Environment
- Rooms feel familiar
- Furniture slightly misaligned
- Clocks stopped at different times

Notes Introduced
- Handwritten notes in **player's handwriting**
- Content:
    - "I already tried this."
    - "This isn't the way."
    - "Don't trust the stairs."

Cognitive Dissonance
Player doesn't remember writing them.

SCENE 7: ELEVATOR RETURN

Duration: 4–5 minutes
Location: Elevator bank

Elevator Rules (Now Broken)
- Floor buttons unlabeled
- Button presses sometimes do nothing
- Elevator opens to unexpected floors

Possible Outcomes
- Opens to identical corridor
- Opens to mirror hallway again
- Opens to empty room

DEATH - WRONG ELEVATOR CHOICE

Trigger

- Certain button press

Execution

- Elevator shakes
- Lights cut
- Sudden stop
- Blackout

Lesson

Vertical choices are guesses, not logic.

SCENE 8: FALSE SAFE ROOM

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Environment

- Warm lighting
- Couch or bed
- Calm ambient sound
- Looks safe

Trap

- Staying longer than ~20 seconds
- Screen darkens slowly
- Audio muffles

DEATH - FALSE REST

Execution

- Breathing slows
- Fade to black

Lesson

Rest is unsafe.

SCENE 9: SHADOW & REFLECTION COMBINATION

Duration: 3–4 minutes

Setup

- Shadow appears only in reflection
- Not visible directly
- Staring at reflection too long = death

Player Must

- Use mirror briefly
- Move immediately

This reinforces restraint.

SCENE 10: EXIT TO Event 4

Duration: 2–3 minutes

Environment

- Corridor stretches unnaturally
- Lighting pulses with footsteps

Exit Door

- Unmarked
- Heavy
- Leads to distorted floor

Checkpoint

Triggers upon opening the door.

Event 4 - DISPLACEMENT

Target Playtime: 30–35 minutes
Tone: Anxiety → Panic → Submission
Player Safety: High risk (behavior-based deaths)
Core Theme: *The hotel reacts to how you play*
Design Rule:

- The environment does not hate the player.
- It punishes **panic, impatience, and mistrust**.

Event 4 GOALS

- Turn player behavior into the main puzzle
- Introduce Shadow **WARNING** → **HUNTER** states
- Break trust in objectives and movement
- Create pressure without constant chases
- Make the player self-police their actions

SCENE 1: ARRIVAL — THE DISTORTED FLOOR

Duration: 3–4 minutes
Location: Transition corridor from Event 3

Environment

- Corridor longer than physically possible
- Ceiling slightly curved
- Lights pulse faintly with footsteps
- Carpet pattern subtly shifts when not observed

Audio

- Player footsteps echo *too long*
- Low sub-bass hum (Shadow warning baseline)

Objective Appears

Proceed forward

This objective will later lie.

SCENE 2: MOVEMENT TEST

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Core Mechanic Introduced (Softly)

- Walking slowly → environment stable
- Running → corridor stretches
- Standing still → lights dim gradually

Player Experimentation

- No death yet
- Just discomfort

Shadow Presence

- Very faint flicker at far distance if player runs repeatedly
- No direct appearance

Lesson

Movement is no longer neutral.

SCENE 3: FIRST BEHAVIOR DEATH

Duration: 4–6 minutes

Setup

- Long straight corridor
- Exit door visible far ahead
- Objective still says: **Proceed forward**

Trap Logic

- Running makes exit recede
- Standing still too long triggers Shadow WARNING

Shadow WARNING STATE

- Lights dim
- Low rumble
- Shadow silhouette at end of hall

Player Choice

- Adjust behavior (walk slowly) → survive
- Panic (run or freeze) → death

DEATH - MOVEMENT MISUSE

- Shadow closes distance instantly
- Blackout

Lesson

Control yourself or die.

SCENE 4: OBJECTIVE BETRAYAL

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Environment

- Forked corridor
- Both paths look identical

Objective Updates

Go left

Truth

- Left path collapses after several steps
- Right path is correct

Shadow Interaction

- If player follows objective blindly:
    - WARNING → HUNTER → death

Lesson

UI lies. Patterns matter.

SCENE 5: REACTIVE LIGHTING PUZZLE

Duration: 5–6 minutes

Environment

- Corridor with light switches
- Darkness compresses space
- Light expands space

Puzzle

- Player must move while managing lighting
- Turning on all lights causes corridor to stretch infinitely
- Turning off all lights causes Shadow WARNING

Optimal Behavior

- Partial lighting
- Slow movement

Shadow Usage

- Appears briefly if lighting mismanaged
- Kills only after repeated mistakes

SCENE 6: SHADOW PATH BLOCK

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Setup
- Narrow corridor
- Shadow stands mid-path

Rule
- Approaching = death
- Backing away slowly = safe

Puzzle
- Player must reroute without panic
- Running causes Hunter state

Lesson
Retreat is not failure.

SCENE 7: SILENCE TEST

Duration: 3–4 minutes

Environment
- Wide open space
- No ambient sound
- Footsteps muffled

Trap
- Silence lasts too long
- Shadow WARNING begins without visual cue

Player Must
- Keep moving
- Use sound cues (own footsteps)

Death Condition
- Standing still too long

SCENE 8: FALSE RESOLUTION

Duration: 3–4 minutes

Environment
- Corridor stabilizes

- Normal proportions
- Warm light
- Calm music returns briefly

Purpose
Lower guard.

Shadow
- Absent

Player Emotion
Relief — briefly.

SCENE 9: FINAL Event 4 TEST

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Combined Mechanics
- Objective lies
- Lighting reacts
- Movement punished
- Shadow WARNING appears twice

No New Rules
Only mastery.

SCENE 10: EXIT TO Event 5

Duration: 2–3 minutes

Exit Door
- Clearly marked
- Looks safe

Shadow Behavior
- Passive observer from distance
- No threat

Checkpoint
Upon opening the door.

Event 5 - FALSE CALM

Target Playtime: 20–25 minutes
Tone: Relief → Unease → Existential dread
Player Safety: Moderate (deceptive deaths)
Core Theme: *Comfort is the deadliest illusion*
Design Rule: Event 5 must feel like the game is ending - when it absolutely isn't.

Event 5 GOALS

- Lower player guard intentionally
- Remove obvious threats
- Make silence, light, and openness dangerous
- Reduce Shadow presence to near-zero
- Create emotional exhaustion
- Prepare the player for the ending psychologically

SCENE 1: THE OPEN SPACE

Duration: 3–4 minutes
Location: Wide hotel corridor / lobby-adjacent space

Environment

- Wider than any previous area
- Higher ceiling
- Warm, soft lighting
- Neutral colors (cream, soft gold)
- Clean walls, no distortion

Audio

- Gentle ambient hum
- No whispers
- No bass rumble
- Footsteps sound normal again

Player Emotion

"I think I'm safe."

SCENE 2: THE ABSENCE

Duration: 3–4 minutes

Design Choice

- No shadow
- No scares
- No music stingers

Environmental Details

- Artwork on walls (abstract, calming)
- Benches or couches
- Indoor plants (slightly artificial)

Subtle Wrongness

- Clock hands don’t move
- Exit signs hum faintly but don’t flicker

Purpose

Let the player relax **too much**.

SCENE 3: THE FIRST COMFORT TRAP

Duration: 4–5 minutes

Setup

- Seating area
- Soft lighting
- Calm soundscape

Trap

- Sitting or standing still too long
- Screen desaturates slowly
- Audio muffles

DEATH — COMFORT STASIS

Execution

- Breathing slows
- Fade to black

Restart

- Player respawns nearby
- No environmental changes

Lesson

Rest is still unsafe.

SCENE 4: FALSE EXITS

Duration: 4–6 minutes

Environment

- Multiple clearly labeled exits:
    - “Lobby”

    - “Street”
    - “Reception”

Design Trick
- Labels are convincing
- Lighting guides toward wrong exits

Player Choice
- Wrong exit → death
- Correct exit → continues

DEATH - FALSE ESCAPE
Execution
- Sudden wind rush
- Brief weightless sensation
- Blackout

Note
No gore. No fall animation.

SCENE 5: THE SHADOW RETURNS (PASSIVE)

Duration: 3–4 minutes

Appearance
- Shadow visible far away
- Sitting or standing
- Not moving
- Watching

Rule
- Cannot kill
- Cannot approach

Psychological Impact
Player *expects* danger — it doesn’t come.

SCENE 6: SILENCE AS A WEAPON

Duration: 3–4 minutes

Environment
- Large, empty space
- Almost total silence
- Footsteps barely audible

Trap

- Standing still triggers slow fade
- Shadow does NOT appear
- No warning cues

Player Must

- Keep moving
- Trust instinct, not rules

Lesson

Silence ≠ safety.

SCENE 7: MEMORY BLEED

Duration: 3–4 minutes

Notes Appear

- Not handwritten
- Printed
- Clinical tone

Examples:

- “Patient exhibits disorganized behavior.”
- “Subject believes environment is hostile.”

Player Reaction

These notes feel **external**, not self-authored.

SCENE 8: THE FINAL FALSE CALM

Duration: 3–4 minutes

Environment

- Lobby-like space
- Morning light
- Large windows
- Clean floor
- No distortion

Audio

- Faint city sounds
- Calm music

Objective Appears

Exit the hotel

This is the most dangerous objective in the game.

SCENE 9: EXIT COMMITMENT

Duration: 2–3 minutes

Exit Door
- Wide
- Glass
- Bright outside

Shadow
- Visible once in reflection
- Passive
- Silent

No Death Here
Player must proceed.

SCENE 10: TRANSITION TO Event 6

Duration: 1–2 minutes

Player Steps Forward
- Sound drops out
- Screen blooms white

Checkpoint
Final checkpoint before ending.

Event 6 - THE WINDOW

Target Playtime: 5–7 minutes
Tone: Calm → Realization → Finality
Player Safety: No deaths / no restarts
Core Theme: *You were never escaping*

SCENE 1 — THE LOBBY

Duration: 2–3 minutes

Environment
- Bright morning lobby
- Clean, modern, completely normal
- Large glass opening ahead, flooded with sunlight

- No distortion
- No flickering
- No impossible geometry

This is the **most stable space in the entire game**.

Audio

- Soft city ambience
- Distant traffic
- No music
- No whispers
- No shadow audio

UI

- No objectives
- No prompts
- Full control

Key Detail

- Reception desk is empty
- Phones are silent
- Clocks are absent

The hotel is no longer reacting.
It's **done**.

The player believes they've made it out.

SCENE 2 - THE EXIT

Duration: 1–2 minutes

Visual Focus

- The glass "exit" dominates the frame
- Outside looks peaceful — but still
- No people
- No wind
- No motion

Subtle Unease

- Reflection in the glass lags slightly
- The glass has:
    - No handle
    - No frame
    - No markings

Final Shadow Appearance

- Shadow visible **once**
- Far behind the player

- Seen only in reflection
- Completely still
- Silent

It does not chase.
It does not warn.
It only **watches**.

This confirms:
Nothing is stopping the player anymore.

SCENE 3 - THE STEP

Duration: ~1 minute

Player Action

- The only clear path is forward
- The game does not instruct or stop the player

The Truth (Never Spoken)

This is not a door.
It is a **window**.

Execution

- Player steps forward
- All sound cuts instantly
- Screen blooms white
- No fall animation
- No impact sound

Reality Intrusion (Audio First)

- Muffled voices
- Sirens
- Radio chatter

Visual Fade-In

- Sky
- Paramedics
- Stretcher

  For a single frame:
  - The hotel window overlays the sky
    Then disappears forever.

End

- Fade to black

Final text:

- *“I thought I was leaving.”*
- *“There was no door.”*
- *(Silence)*

References

Floor 9
Anant Express
Water Delivery
Baby Blues Nightmares - Toddler Horror Game
Exit 8
The Séance of Blake Manor (art style, story driven)
The Forest (creative and horror survival elements)
Hellblade: Senua's Sacrifice (psychological sound design)